INCH-POUND

A-A-50356B
1 March 1990

SUPERSEDING
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30 September 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HANDKERCHIEF, MEN'S OR WOMEN'S

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to DDD-H-71H, Types I and II, Classes 1, 2, and 3, Styles A and B.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

1.1 Classification. The handkerchiefs shall be furnished in the following types, classes, and styles (see 4.2).

Type I	- Men's, 15-1/2 by 15-1/2 inches 1/
Type II	- Women's, 10 by 10 inches 1/
Class 1	- White
Class 2	- Brown 436 2/
Style A	- Cotton
Style B	- Cotton/Polyester 3/

1/ Tolerance ± 1/4 inch.

2/ The Brown 436 handkerchief shall be procured only as Style A - Cotton.

3/ The cotton/polyester blend shall contain no more than 65% polyester.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Officer in Charge, Navy Clothing and Textile Research Facility, 21 Strathmore Road, Natick, MA 01760-2490 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8440/8445

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1.2 General description.

1.2.1 Material. The handkerchiefs shall be plain weave, constructed from 100% cotton or cotton/polyester blend with a minimum yarn count of 63 yarns per inch in the warp and 52 in the filling with a minimum weight of 1.80 ounces per square yard. The base fabric may have ornamental stripes in the warp or filling direction.

1.2.1.1 Color and colorfastness. The color of the class 1 handkerchief shall be bleached white. The color of the class 2 handkerchief shall be Brown 436 and shall match the standard sample for shade and appearance. The class 2 handkerchief shall show fastness to laundering (after 3 cycles) and perspiration equal to or better than the standard sample or equal to or better than a rating of "good". The class 2 handerchief shall show fastness to crocking equal to or better than the standard sample or shall have an AATCC Chromatic Transference Scale rating of not less than 3.5 (see 2.2.2). (NOTE: Reactive dyes have successfully provided these colorfastness characteristics.) The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited.

1.2.2 Thread. The thread for the class 1 handkerchief shall be cotton, spun polyester or cotton/polyester. The thread for the class 2 handkerchief shall be cotton conforming to the requirements of V-T-276.

1.2.2.1 Color and colorfastness. The thread for the class 1 handkerchief shall be bleached white. The thread for the class 2 handkerchief shall be Khaki P-1, C.A. 66019 or equal. The dyed thread shall show colorfastness to laundering after 3 cycles equal to or better than the standard sample when tested as specified in V-T-276.

1.2.3 Hemming. All handkerchiefs shall be finished square. The hems of the handkerchief shall be made using seam type EFb-1, with either a 304 stitch modified to produce a single needle hemstitched hem or a plain 304 zig-zag stitched hem. There shall not be less than 10 stitches per inch. The hems shall finish 3/8 to 5/8 inches wide for type I, and 3/16 to 5/16 for type II. As an alternate, a rolled hem, 3/32 (min.) inch width may be used. All edges shall be hemmed.

1.3 Workmanship. The handkerchiefs shall be uniform in quality and shall be free from irregularities or defects which adversely affect performance, reliability, or durability.

1.4 Product demonstration model. During the solicitation phase, interested firms shall provide the Procuring Agency with two product demonstration models of the item they propose to furnish for evaluation. The two samples provided by the successful offerer shall be tagged and sealed. One shall be retained by the Procuring Agency and the other furnished the assigned Quality Assurance Representative for use as a reference in performing the examination in paragraph 2.3 and the scoring of defects in design, material and workmanship not otherwise classified herein.

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2. QUALITY ASSURANCE

2.1 Certification. When requested by the contracting officer, the contractor shall certify, and maintain substantiating evidence, that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

2.2 Component testing (class 2 only).

2.2.1 Sampling. Testing shall be performed for the characteristics specified in 2.2.2 and in accordance with the referenced test methods of FED-STD-191 and AATCC. Testing for the requirements listed in 2.2.2 is applicable to the sample unit. The lot size shall be expressed in units of yards and the sample unit shall be 1 yard full width of the cloth. The sample size (number of sample units) shall be as shown below:

Lot size (yards)	Sample size (units)
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

2.2.2 Colorfastness testing. Colorfastness requirements for the class 2 handkerchief (see 1.2.1.1) shall be tested in accordance with FED-STD-191 and AATCC with the following test methods.

Colorfastness to:	Test Method
Laundering (after 3 cycles)	5610 1/ 2/ 3/
Crocking	AATCC No. 8
Perspiration	5680 3/

1/ The specimens must be dried after each of the 3 laundering cycles.

2/ Only the stain on the cotton fibers of the transfer cloth shall be evaluated.

3/ FED-STD-191

2.3 Examination of the end item. The handkerchiefs shall be inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The defects found during the examination of the end item will be classified below. The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one handkerchief and the sample unit shall be one completely finished handkerchief.

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Defects	Classification Major	Minor
I. MATERIAL DEFECTS AND WORKMANSHIP DAMAGE		
A. Any hole, cut, tear, smash, needle chew, abraded surface, or broken or missing yarn	X	
B. Any hem omitted, twisted, puckered or pleated	X	
C. Any open hem or raw edge due to broken stitches	X	
D. Color not as specified	X	
II. CLEANNESS		
A. Any spot or stain		X
B. Thread ends not trimmed		X
III. DESIGN AND ASSEMBLY		
A. Not cut or fabricated in accordance with the product demonstration model	X	
IV. GENERAL		
A. Any defect not otherwise classified herein but at variance with the product demonstration model		X
V. DIMENSIONS		
A. Any dimension out of tolerances specified	X	

3. PRESERVATION, PACKING AND MARKING

3.1 Preservation and packing. Four (4) handkerchiefs shall be packaged into a polyethylene bag. Seven hundred twenty (720) handkerchiefs preserved as specified, (180 bags of 4) of one type, class and style only, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275, size 2A of MIL-B-17757. The liner shall be type CF, class domestic, in accordance with the requirements of MIL-B-17757. The box shall be closed in accordance with the box specification.

3.2 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, unit packs, intermediate or exterior containers, and palletized unit loads shall marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.3 Palletization. When specified (see 4.2), item, packed as specified in 3.1, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with the bonding methods C and D or Film bonding F or G. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. The pallet shall be 4-way, type IV; type V, class 1, size 2; or type VIII, fabricated from wood groups I, II, III or IV, grade A of NN-P-71, or 4-way, style 1, size A, type I, class 1 fabricated from groups specified of MIL-P-15011. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contacting officer.

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4. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

4.1 Intended use. The handkerchiefs covered by this document are intended for use by civil and military government personnel.

4.2 *Acquisition requirements*. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification
b. Type, class, and style required (see 1.1)
c. When palletization is required (see 3.3)

4.3 Dyestuff combination. A suggested but not mandatory dyestuff combination for Brown 436 is as follows:

Reactive Yellow 84
Reactive Scarlet H-EA
Reactive Blue 160

4.4 Source of government documents. Copies of military and federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

4.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Navy - NU
Army - GL
Air Force - 99

Review activities:
Air Force - 11, 82
DLA - CT

User activities:
Navy - MC
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Navy - NU

Civil coordination agencies:
VA - OSS
GSA - FSS

Project 8440-0188

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